Chroma

Overview › Getting Started

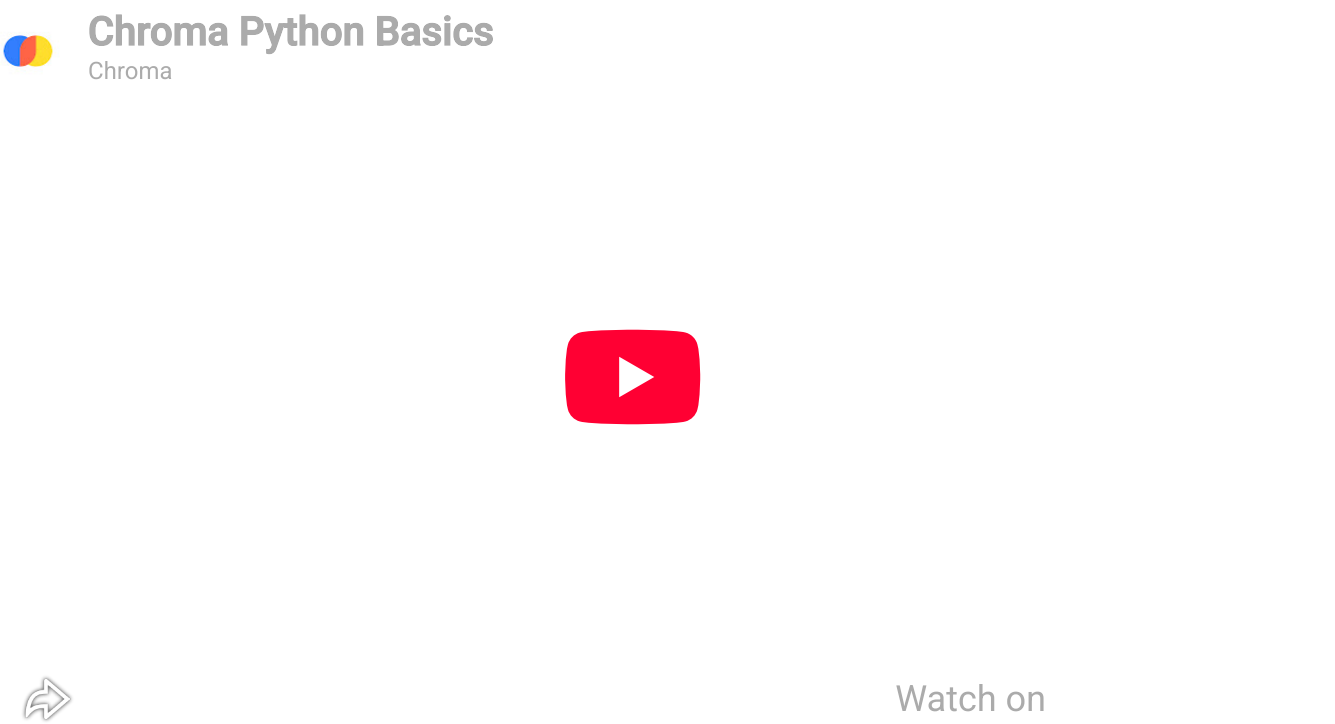
Overview

Getting Started

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Chroma is the open-source data infrastructure for AI. It comes with everything you need to get started built-in, and runs on your machine.

Python TypeScript Rust



For production, Chroma offers **Chroma Cloud** - a fast, scalable, and serverless database-as-a-service. Get started in 30 seconds - $5 in free credits included.

Install with AI

Chroma

```
In this directory create a new Python project with Chroma set up.
Use a virtual environment.

Write a small example that adds some data to a collection and queries it.
Do not delete the data from the collection when it's complete.
Run the script when you are done setting up the environment and writing the
script. The output should show what data was ingested, what was the query,
```

··· See all 28 lines

Install Manually

1 Install

pip poetry uv

```
pip install chromadb
```

2 Create a Chroma Client

Python

```
import chromadb
chroma_client = chromadb.Client()
```

3 Create a collection

Collections are where you'll store your embeddings, documents, and any additional metadata. Collections index your embeddings and documents, and enable efficient

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```
collection = chroma_client.create_collection(name="my_collection")
```

4 Add some text documents to the collection

Chroma will store your text and handle embedding and indexing automatically. You can also customize the embedding model. You must provide unique string IDs for your documents.

Python

```python
collection.add(
    ids=["id1", "id2"],
    documents=[
        "This is a document about pineapple",
        "This is a document about oranges"
    ]
)
```

5 Query the collection

You can query the collection with a list of query texts, and Chroma will return the n most similar results. It's that easy!

Python

```python
results = collection.query(
    query_texts=["This is a query document about hawaii"], # Chroma will
    n_results=2 # how many results to return
)
print(results)
```

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From the above - you can see that our query about hawaii is semantically most similar to the document about pineapple.

Python

```
{
  'documents': [[
      'This is a document about pineapple',
      'This is a document about oranges'
  ]],
  'ids': [['id1', 'id2']],
  'distances': [[1.0404009819030762, 1.2430804967880025]],
  'uris': None,
  'data': None,
  'metadatas': [[None, None]],
  'embeddings': None,
}
```

7 Try it out yourself

What if we tried querying with “This is a document about florida”? Here is a full example.

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```
# switch \`create_collection\` to \`get_or_create_collection\` to avoid c
collection = chroma_client.get_or_create_collection(name="my_collection")

# switch \`add\` to \`upsert\` to avoid adding the same documents every t
```

See all 21 lines

Next steps

In this guide we used Chroma's **in-memory client** for simplicity. It starts a Chroma server in-memory, so any data you ingest will be lost when your program terminates. You can use the **persistent client** or run Chroma in **client-server mode** if you need data persistence.

- Learn how to **Deploy Chroma** to a server
- Join Chroma's **Discord Community** to ask questions and get help
- Follow Chroma on **X (@trychroma)** for updates

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